

TOOL 4 • CROSS-FUNCTIONAL ALIGNMENT

The Seam Handoff Standard (Internal SLA)

**The Seam Rule:** Friction thrives in undefined handoffs between peer departments. When departments point fingers, do not mediate personal disputes—draw a hard, contractual boundary line. Define what enters the seam, what criteria must be met, and how misses are resolved.

PART 1: THE OPERATIONAL SEAM

|                                                    |                                |
|----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| SENDING TEAM (DEPARTMENT A):                       | RECEIVING TEAM (DEPARTMENT B): |
| <div></div>                                        | <div></div>                    |
| WORK PRODUCT / DELIVERABLE MOVING ACROSS THE SEAM: |                                |
| <div></div>                                        |                                |

PART 2: THE INTAKE STANDARD (ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA)

WHAT MUST BE TRUE FOR DEPARTMENT B TO ACCEPT THE WORK WITHOUT REWORK, DELAY, OR KICKBACK?

|                                                                   |                                                            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Required Form / Fields 100% Complete     | <input type="checkbox"/> Technical Specs & Assets Attached |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Budget / Stakeholder Approval Documented | <input type="checkbox"/> Hard Customer Due Date Specified  |

SPECIFIC PREREQUISITE CHECKLIST & REQUIRED ARTIFACTS:

PART 3: THE RESPONSE STANDARD (TURNAROUND COMMITMENT)

|                                                                 |                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| DEPARTMENT B TURNAROUND TIME (UPON RECEIVING COMPLETE HANDOFF): | ACKNOWLEDGMENT STANDARD (TIME TO CONFIRM RECEIPT): |
| <div></div>                                                     | <div></div>                                        |

PART 4: RESOLUTION PROTOCOL WHEN STANDARD IS MISSED

|                                                                          |                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1ST MISS PROTOCOL (RESOLVED DIRECTLY BETWEEN PEER OWNERS WITHIN 24 HRS): | 2ND MISS ESCALATION (JOINT ROOT-CAUSE AUTOPSY BEFORE DEPARTMENT HEADS): |
| <div></div>                                                              | <div></div>                                                             |

PART 5: INTER-DEPARTMENTAL MUTUAL COMMITMENT

|                               |                               |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| <div></div>                   | <div></div>                   |
| Department A Leader Signature | Department B Leader Signature |
| Date                          | Date                          |